

Do You Know the Ingredients of Your Software?

Just like food, the software solutions you consume are also made up of different ingredients. These include third-party software (supplied by vendors outside your organisation) along with other open source software components and libraries that collectively form the ingredients of the software application. Organisations must adopt a compliance strategy to avoid the risks associated with releasing a product that does not comply with the underlying licences.

Lack of awareness about open source software compliance and software security risks can result in various compliance related issues.

Before it is consumed by an end user, the product team and stakeholders should understand their software's composition. Unless you are aware of the potential risks your software may have, you cannot remediate that risk. To understand the risk

associated with open source software, it is essential to know how it enters your supply chain.

What is open source software and how does it enter your supply chain?

Open source software is computer software that is released under a licence in which the copyright holder grants users the right to use, study, modify, and

distribute the software and its source code to anyone and for any purpose.

Modern applications such as mobiles, the cloud and IoT connected devices may comprise up to 90 per cent of open source, according to a report by Forrester. Open source components are malleable in nature because one can copy, redistribute, and even make changes to the software, for any purpose. This makes it favourable for

